

CERTIFICATION HANDBOOK FOR CHAPTER LEADS

CHAPTER REPLICATION GUIDE

This is the whole training program for running a Tech Awareness Chapter. You work through it alone, at your own pace. Finishing the reading doesn't make you a chapter lead. Getting your certification submission approved does.

FOUNDED AND DIRECTED BY RONIT SHARMA
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FIG. 01 · WORKSHOP STATION, HOST LIBRARY

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CONDENSED FIELD EDITION. PART 8 (THE KNOWLEDGE CHECK) AND APPENDICES A TO F LIVE IN THE FULL HANDBOOK.

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THE PATH, IN ONE LINE

Application → handbook → Modules 1 to 5 → knowledge check → two videos → charter → first workshop → full status after three reported workshops.

HOW TO USE THIS HANDBOOK

This isn't reading material. It's a course. Five modules, each with a checkpoint you have to actually do, then a written knowledge check and a certification submission at the end.

Here's why it works this way: TAA is small and growing fast. We can't personally train every chapter lead, and we're not going to pretend we can. So we wrote down everything we know and built a way to check that you actually learned it.

Steps 4 and 5 are real gates, and yes, we do turn people away at them. Not because we enjoy being difficult. It's the reason a library trusts a stranger in their building under our name.

DON'T RUSH IT

If you try to knock this out in a weekend, you'll fail the certification submission. The hands-on parts need you to take devices apart and put them back together over and over, and that takes days, not hours.

THE PATH FROM APPLICANT TO CHAPTER

STAGE	WHAT YOU DO	WHO DECIDES
1 • Application	Submit the form your library posted	TAA reviews
2 • Handbook issued	You get this document and your toolkit	No gate here
3 • Modules 1 to 5	Self-study, roughly 12 to 18 hours total	You
4 • Knowledge check	Complete Part 8 in writing, submit it	TAA reviews
5 • Certification	Two videos: one repair, one mock lesson	TAA reviews
6 • Chartered	Tools, materials, library introduction confirmed	TAA issues charter
7 • First workshop	Run it. Submit the post-workshop report	You + TAA
8 • Full charter	After three completed workshops with reports	TAA confirms

45m

PART 1

4h

MODULE 1

7h

MODULE 2

4h

MODULE 3

3h

MODULE 4

3h

MODULE 5

3h

PARTS 8 + 9

WHAT TECH AWARENESS ASSOCIATION IS

We make technology repairable and understandable for the people the tech industry stopped designing for. We do two things, in public, for free:

01 · DEVICE REPAIR

People open up, diagnose, and fix their own phones, laptops, tablets, and watches. Their own hands, real tools.

02 · DIGITAL LITERACY

People learn to use the devices they already own without fear: settings, storage, backups, passwords, and how to spot a scam.

TAA started with a rejection. Our founder pitched a device-repair club at school and got turned down. Turns out the idea never needed a school. It needed a room, a table, some tools, and people who wanted to learn, and public libraries have all four. Nobody handed TAA a budget or permission. Your chapter gets built the same way.



A library workshop in session
or [browse files](#)

FIG. 02 · WE RUN IN LIBRARIES AND SENIOR CENTERS, THE PLACES ANYONE CAN WALK INTO WITHOUT PAYING OR EXPLAINING THEMSELVES

WHAT WE BELIEVE

01

A DEVICE YOU CANNOT OPEN IS A DEVICE YOU DO NOT OWN

Manufacturers spent twenty years making repair harder: glued batteries, weird screws, serialized parts. That's power moving away from ordinary people, and we teach repair as a way of taking some of it back.

02

THE PERSON DOES THE REPAIR. NOT US.

The hardest rule we have. If you leave a workshop having personally fixed twelve devices while twelve people watched, you failed. We're a teaching organization, not a repair counter.

03

FAILURE IS PART OF THE LESSON, AND WE PLAN FOR IT

Someone will strip a screw. Someone will tear a ribbon cable. Good. That's what learning looks like, and it's why we practice on devices we own instead of people's real phones.

04

NOBODY GETS CONDESCENDED TO

Our attendees ran businesses, taught school, wired houses, kept books. They're capable adults who were never shown this one particular thing. The second your tone slips into baby talk, you've lost them, and they won't come back.

05

BROKEN THINGS ARE A RESOURCE, NOT GARBAGE

Around sixty million tons of e-waste gets generated worldwide every year, and only a fraction gets properly recycled. Every device a chapter keeps alive is one that never becomes trash, and every dead one is teaching material or spare parts.

[READ THIS FIRST](#)

If any of these five bugs you, this isn't the right organization for you. Better to figure that out now, on this page.

WHO BACKS US, AND WHAT A CHAPTER IS

4

TOWNS WITH OPERATING CHAPTERS

~110

ENTERPRISE DEVICES DONATED BY GRANITE GIVES BACK

72+38

SFF DESKTOPS + LAPTOPS, DELL AND LENOVO UNITS

100

TESTED 8GB DDR4 MODULES FOR TEACHING UPGRADES

You're not starting from zero. When you walk into a library, you represent an organization running in four towns, with corporate hardware from **Granite Telecommunications'** **Granite Gives Back** program and a curriculum that's been tested on real attendees. Our toolkits and required reading come from **iFixit**, the biggest open repair knowledge platform there is.

□ OPEN ITEMS · CONFIRM BEFORE DISTRIBUTING

Name the four towns and host venues. State the exact 501(c)(3) status. Describe the iFixit relationship only in terms iFixit has agreed to in writing. Overstating a partner in a document you hand to strangers is how partnerships end.



Donated practice hardware

or [browse files](#)

FIG. 03 · PRACTICE INVENTORY: GRANITE GIVES BACK DESKTOPS AND LAPTOPS

A TECH AWARENESS CHAPTER. EVERY WORD HERE IS A REQUIREMENT.

RECURRING At least once a month. One workshop is an event, not a chapter.	FREE Attendees never pay. No fee, no door donation, no materials charge.	PUBLIC Anyone can walk in. No screening, no membership, no age limit.
FIXED VENUE A library or senior center. Not your house, not a coffee shop, not a garage.	CERTIFIED LEAD That's you, after you pass Parts 8 and 9. Not before.	TAA NAME Our materials, our safety rules, honest representation. In exchange you get the name, the toolkit, the hardware, and the introduction.

- x NOT A REPAIR SHOP

x NOT A BUSINESS

x NOT A PERSONAL BRAND
- x NOT UNSUPERVISED

WHO RUNSTAA



Portrait: Ronit Sharma
or [browse files](#)

RONIT SHARMA

EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR



Portrait: Tanay Mangal
or [browse files](#)

TANAY MANGAL

PROGRAMS & EDUCATION



Portrait: Nathan Anwin
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NATHAN ANWIN

OPERATIONS & LOGISTICS



Portrait: Suhaas Goluguri
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SUHAAS GOLUGURI

OUTREACH & COMMUNITY



Portrait: Ekansh Jain
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EKANSH JAIN

FINANCE & IMPACT



Portrait: Suhrit Ghosh
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SUHRIT GHOSH

SOCIAL MEDIA LEAD

CHAPTER ROLES & CODE OF CONDUCT

CHAPTER LEAD

The person on the hook for everything. Owns the venue relationship, the safety briefing, the inventory, the report, and the call to stop a repair.

CERTIFIED · PARTS 8 + 9

CO-LEAD

Your backup. Recruit one within ninety days. A one-person chapter is one bad week away from ending, and most dead chapters died exactly that way.

CERTIFIED · PARTS 8 + 9

REPAIR INSTRUCTOR

Runs one station of 2 to 4 attendees. Coaches through the escalation ladder: words first, pointing second, hands almost never.

MODULES 1, 2, 4, 5 + CHECK

DIGITAL LITERACY INSTRUCTOR

The non-repair half of the mission, and often the most impactful seat in the room. A patient retiree or a librarian usually beats a hotshot technician here.

MODULES 1 (SAFETY), 4, 5

INTAKE & GREETER

The first face people see. Sign-in, acknowledgment form, "what brought you in today?", the queue, and the attendance count.

MODULE 4 + SAFETY BRIEFING

INVENTORY STEWARD

Counts tools in and out, tracks practice devices, keeps consumables stocked, and handles battery storage and disposal. Chapters lose toolkits. It's embarrassing and expensive.

MODULE 1 IN FULL · METICULOUS

LIBRARY LIAISON

Optional. Someone on the inside at the venue who helps with booking, promotion, and the stuff you'd otherwise learn the hard way.

VENUE STAFF OR REGULAR PATRON

RULE OF THUMB

One person can hold two roles. Nobody should hold four. Recruit the way you got recruited: through the library, and through people who showed up and liked it.

CODE OF CONDUCT. YOU AGREE TO ALL TEN AS A CONDITION OF YOUR CHARTER.

- | | |
|--|---|
| 01 · Never charge, solicit, or accept payment under the TAA name | 06 · Never claim partnerships, funding, or status TAA doesn't have |
| 02 · Never use a workshop to drum up business for anyone | 07 · Treat every attendee as a capable adult |
| 03 · Run the safety briefing before anyone picks up a tool | 08 · Report honestly, including the workshops that flopped |
| 04 · Follow the practice-device policy, no exceptions | 09 · Report injuries, damage, or serious incidents within 24 hours |
| 05 · Stop any repair you believe has become unsafe | 10 · Never touch an attendee's accounts, photos, messages, or files |

POINT 10, PLAINLY

You'll be handed unlocked phones by people who trust you. Don't ask for a passcode you don't need. Don't take a device out of the room. Don't touch an account. If a repair needs the phone unlocked, the owner unlocks it and keeps their hands on it.

TOOLS, WORKBENCH, AND SAFETY

Every serious repair failure comes down to one of three things: the wrong tool, a lost screw, or a battery.

THE KIT • IFIXIT PRO TECH TOOLKIT

64-bit driver	Phillips, Torx, Pentalobe, JIS, Tri-point and more. Seat the bit fully, press down, turn steadily.
Nylon spudger x2	Your go-to around connectors and boards. Pointed end for cables, blunt end for prying.
Plastic opening tools x3	The default pry. Not sure which tool to grab? It's usually this one.
Opening picks x6	Cut and hold screen adhesive. They wear out, so buy extras.
ESD tweezers x3	Screws, ribbon cables, tight spots. Genuinely sharp, and never a prying tool.
Suction cup	Lifts glued displays. Warm the screen first; tape over shattered glass.
Metal spudger • Jimmy	For stubborn casings only. Not ESD safe. These stay in the Lead's hands, not an attendee's.
Wrist strap • magnetic mat	The two most underestimated things in the kit. More on both at right.

Buy separately: 91%+ isopropyl, lint-free swabs, nitrile gloves, a good light, adhesive strips, a multimeter, and a fireproof battery container.

SCREW DISCIPLINE • THE MAT METHOD

- 1 Draw the device outline on the mat before you open anything
- 2 Each screw goes on the mat in the position it came from
- 3 Circle and label each group: "back cover", "shield", "bracket"
- 4 On reassembly, work backwards through the mat
- 5 Can't account for every screw? Don't close the device.

A screw one millimeter too long, driven into the wrong hole, can punch straight through a logic board. **The mat gets used or the repair doesn't start.** Hand attendees the marker; drawing the outline turns them from a passenger into the person running the process.

ESD • THE DAMAGE YOU CAN'T FEEL

You're carrying a static charge you can't feel, and a zap way below anything you'd notice can quietly damage a chip. The damage often shows up later: the device works today and dies in three weeks. In a teaching setting, that's the worst possible outcome.

- Wrist strap on, clipped to unpainted metal, before the case opens
- Touch grounded metal before handling any board
- No wool, fleece, or shuffling around on carpet in socks
- Boards go into antistatic bags or onto the mat, never onto fabric
- Metal spudger and Jimmy are not ESD safe; nylon and ESD tweezers are

BITS YOU'LL ACTUALLY MEET:
PH000 TO PH1 • P2/P5 PENTALOBE • Y000 TRI-POINT • T2 TO T8 TORX • JIS (STRIPS IF YOU USE A PHILLIPS BIT ON IT)



A station: mat, light, strap
or [browse files](#)

FIG. 04 • STATION SETUP: HARD SURFACE, MAT, DIRECTIONAL LIGHT

BATTERY SAFETY: NO EXCEPTIONS, EVER

Puncture a lithium cell and it can vent superheated gas and catch fire. This is the one thing in the whole curriculum that can put someone in a hospital.

THE SEVEN RULES

1 · Below 25% charge before any repair near a battery. iFixit tested this: a punctured cell at about 25% smoked and sparked but never hit thermal runaway. A full cell is a completely different event.

3 · Never pry against the face of a cell. Pull the tabs, use isopropyl, use gentle heat, be patient. A battery that won't come out is information, not a challenge.

5 · Punctured cell? Everyone backs away. Forget the repair and the data. No water. Don't breathe the gas. Fire beyond a quick spark means evacuate and pull the alarm.

7 · You are the last word. An attendee may push you to keep going. Say no. This is the one spot in this handbook where you overrule the person who owns the device.

2 · Plastic tools only near a battery. Always. No metal spudger, no Jimmy, no screwdriver, no knife.

4 · A swollen battery ends the repair. Bulging cover, lifting screen, a device that won't sit flat. Full procedure at right.

6 · Batteries never go in the trash. Tape the terminals, into the container, off to a real battery recycling drop-off. Lots of libraries already have one. Ask.

REQUIRED AT EVERY WORKSHOP: FIREPROOF CONTAINER WITH A LID · NITRILE GLOVES · KNOW WHERE THE EXTINGUISHER IS · A ROOM YOU CAN CLEAR FAST. NO CONTAINER, NO BATTERY WORK.

THE SWOLLEN BATTERY PROCEDURE, EVERY SINGLE TIME

- 01 Stop. Tools down.
- 02 Don't press, bend, flex, or pry the device
- 03 Power it off. Don't charge it.
- 04 Into the fireproof container
- 05 Tell the attendee straight: it's a fire risk, don't use or charge it, it needs a professional. Hand them the referral list.
- 06 Log it in the post-workshop report

You'll feel like you're letting them down. You're not. You're the person in the room who knew what they were looking at.

THE UNIVERSAL REPAIR SEQUENCE

Every repair on every device follows the same nine steps. Teach the sequence itself. It's worth more than any single repair, because it transfers to devices we never covered.

01 • LISTEN

Let them describe the problem all the way through without jumping in to guess. "It's slow," "it shuts off," and "the screen went dark" are three different problems.

02 • REPRODUCE

Make the fault happen in front of you. If you can't reproduce it, you can't prove you fixed it.

03 • ASK THE BORING QUESTIONS

How old is it? What changed? Was it dropped? Was it wet? And the single best diagnostic question there is: "has anyone worked on it before?"

04 • RULE OUT SOFTWARE

Reboot, check storage, battery health, updates, and any app installed the week it started. This step alone solves a third of what walks in the door.

05 • RESEARCH

Look up the exact model on iFixit. Read the whole guide first, and read the comments, because that's where you find out step 14 breaks the flex cable.

06 • PLAN THE EXIT

What's the failure mode of this repair, and what do you do if it happens? If there's data on it the owner cares about and it isn't backed up, back it up or stop.

07 • DISASSEMBLE DELIBERATELY

Mat out, screws mapped, photos as you go. Stop at the first weird resistance and figure out why. Force isn't a technique. It's a decision to break something.

08 • TEST BEFORE CLOSING

Power on and test the fault plus the basics: display, touch, sound, charging, buttons. Finding a dead speaker after you've re-glued the screen means doing the repair twice.

09 • DEBRIEF

What was wrong, what fixed it, what to watch for. If it was the battery, explain what battery health means and how to slow the decline.

1/3

of "broken" devices are actually software: full storage, a failed update, a rogue app, a setting. Always rule out software before you open anything.

The highest satisfaction-per-minute repair in existence: a plug of pocket lint packed into the charging port. Wooden toothpick, gentle scraping, phone off, no metal. It's the perfect first win for a nervous attendee.

WHAT'S REALISTIC, BY DEVICE CLASS

DESKTOPS EASIEST. START NERVOUS ATTENDEES HERE. ✓ RAM and storage installs ✓ PSU, fans, dust removal ✓ CMOS battery, OS reinstall ✓ No-POST basics ✗ Check donated units for BIOS supervisor locks before you build a lesson around them	LAPTOPS THE BEST TEACHING CLASS ✓ HDD to SSD (the most dramatic upgrade a user will ever feel) ✓ RAM, battery, keyboard ✓ Fan clean + thermal paste ✓ Linux on aging machines ✗ Board-level work · hinge welding. And always disconnect the internal battery first.	PHONES MOST REQUESTED, LEAST FORGIVING ✓ Port cleaning, battery swaps on moderate-rated models ✓ Screens rated moderate or below ✓ Battery health, backups, scam recognition ✗ Soldering · water damage · Face ID / Touch ID (serialized, breaks for good)	TABLETS LARGE PHONES, WORSE ADHESIVE ✓ Port cleaning, settings, storage ✓ Accessibility configuration ✓ Text size, screen zoom, video calling. Don't underrate this. ✗ Screen swaps as an attendee activity on most big tablets	WEARABLES HARDEST COMMON CLASS. BE HONEST. ✓ Bands, charging contacts ✓ Fall detection, heart rate and accessibility settings, which is usually the more valuable session anyway ✗ Watch displays and batteries as attendee hands-on · anything needing water-resistance resealing
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STOP AND REFER WHEN

Swollen battery · water damage · soldering required · a serialized part that breaks a feature they rely on · top-tier iFixit difficulty · unbacked-up data at risk · missing tool or part · repair costs close to replacement · **your gut says stop**. If you feel out of your depth, you are. Saying "this is past what I can safely do here, and here's who can" is what competence sounds like.

REQUIRED VIEWING

THE ACTIVE VIEWING PROTOCOL

Watching repair videos on the couch is entertainment. It builds zero skill. Follow this or the module is wasted:

- 1 Watch once at normal speed, hands empty, phone away
- 2 Watch again with a practice device in front of you, pausing at every step and doing it
- 3 Write down every warning. A warning is the compressed experience of someone who already broke one.
- 4 Study how they talk. The good ones narrate their reasoning, not just their actions. That's exactly the style you'll use at a workshop table.
- 5 Watch their recoveries. Someone calmly fixing a mistake on camera is the most valuable footage in the whole video.

ASSIGNED CHANNELS. WATCH SEVERAL; ONE PRESENTER'S HABITS AREN'T THE WHOLE CRAFT.

Phone Repair Guru	Your main phone channel. Beginner-friendly, full walkthroughs. ASSIGNED: 4 FULL REPAIRS: SCREEN, BATTERY, CHARGE PORT, ONE DIAGNOSTIC
iFixit	Teardowns and tool technique. Pair each video with the written guide for the same device. ASSIGNED: 2 TEARDOWNS OF DEVICES IN YOUR INVENTORY
Hugh Jeffreys	Full restorations, smart parts sourcing, and the best explanation anywhere of parts pairing and serialization. ASSIGNED: 2 RESTORATIONS + 1 ON SERIALIZATION
JerryRigEverything	How devices are actually built. Watch critically; it's not a model for how to handle an attendee's device. ASSIGNED: 2 TEARDOWNS
Louis Rossmann	The why behind right to repair, plus diagnostic thinking way above workshop level. You're not learning to microsolder. You're learning to think like a technician. ASSIGNED: 1 DIAGNOSTIC + 1 INDUSTRY VIDEO

Before you move on, you should be able to: describe how much force a pick takes under a glued screen · tell adhesive releasing apart from glass starting to crack · narrate a repair out loud · explain serialization to a non-technical person in under a minute · recover from a mistake without visibly panicking.

TEACHING OLDER ADULTS

None of this is about capability. Think of it as accommodation, the same way a lecture hall has a microphone.

VISION Print handouts at 14pt or bigger. Task lighting at every station. Bump up the device's own text size first, and do it with them so they can do it again at home.	HEARING Face the person when you talk. Lower your pitch instead of raising your volume; shouting raises pitch and makes it worse. Never talk from behind someone.	FINE MOTOR Tremor and arthritis are common, and people usually don't mention them. Reverse tweezers hold without grip. Stable surface, elbow support, both hands braced. Never rush a hand.	MEMORY New sequences take longer; judgment is fine. One step at a time, written steps to take home, and explain why each step exists. People hold onto reasons way better than sequences.	ANXIETY Twenty years of being told they're "bad with computers." Some have broken something and been blamed for it. It's the biggest barrier in the room, and it's entirely psychological.
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THE DISCUSSION-BASED MODEL. TAA DOES NOT LECTURE. EVER.

Open with their problem, not your topic.
"What's the thing about your phone that annoys you most? Go around." Everyone talks once in the first five minutes, and now you have the room's real agenda.

Teach toward what they said. If four people said "storage full," that's your lead topic today, whatever your plan was.

Ask, don't tell. "Why do you think the manufacturer glued this in instead of using clips?" starts a better right-to-repair conversation than any speech you could give.

Let them answer each other. An explanation from a peer lands harder than one from an expert, and it turns attendees into volunteers. Close with commitments: "what are you going to try this week?"



An instructor coaching, hands off
or [browse files](#)

FIG. 05 • A CONVERSATION AROUND A TABLE WHERE THINGS ARE GETTING TAKEN APART

LANGUAGE RULES & HARD MOMENTS

DON'T SAY

SAY INSTEAD

"It's easy"	"It takes practice. Everybody fumbles this at first."
"You just tap there"	"Tap there." Delete the word "just" entirely.
"Let me do it"	"Try it. I'll talk you through it."
"No, not that one"	"Close. Try the one right above it."
"I already explained that"	Explain it again, differently, with no comment
"For someone your age, you're doing great"	"You're doing great"
"Your phone is really old"	"Your phone is a few generations back. Here's what that means for you."

"Just" is the most common condescension in tech teaching.
"You just go to settings" tells a struggling person that the thing beating them is trivial. Cut it from your vocabulary at the table.

THE HARD MOMENTS

"I'm too old for this." Don't argue and don't over-reassure; both feel dismissive. Point at the evidence: "You've used this phone for three years without anyone showing you how. That's not someone who can't learn. That's someone nobody ever taught."

The person who was scammed. Stop what you're doing. No alarm, and never "how did you fall for that." These scams are built by professionals to be convincing. Help them change the password and turn on two-factor, their hands on the phone, not yours, and give them reportfraud.ftc.gov.

The dominant talker. "Good, hold that thought, I want to come back to it. Margaret, what did you find?" Then call on the quiet people by name. And consider recruiting the talker; that energy is useful in the right seat.

The person who came for something else. Loneliness, or a family that stopped answering tech questions. That's legitimate. The digital literacy track exists partly for this, and a chapter that only counts repairs misses most of its impact.

WHAT NEVER HAPPENS AT A TAA WORKSHOP
Nobody gets laughed at · no question gets treated as obvious · no device gets taken without asking ("May I?", and hand it back screen facing them) · nobody gets told they're too old · no talking about attendees where they can hear · no accounts, photos, or messages get opened · no passcode gets written down · no device leaves the room.

THE ESCALATION LADDER

WHY FAILURE IS THE CURRICULUM

Someone who watched you replace a battery learned that battery replacement is *possible*. Someone who replaced one themselves, badly, slowly, with two mistakes and one small panic, learned that **they** can replace a battery. Only the second one changes what they do after they go home.

Anyone can follow twelve steps. A repairer is someone who can handle step seven going wrong. Recovery is the real skill, which is why people have to be allowed to fail in front of you, inside the safe boundary the practice-device policy draws.

THE FAILURE MODE TO WATCH FOR

Jumping straight to rung 7 because it's faster. It is faster. It's also the whole reason a workshop can feel busy and teach nobody anything.

"JUST FIX IT FOR ME"

"I could do that in five minutes, but then next time you'd be right back here. Give me twenty and you'll be able to do it yourself." The line is capability, not willingness. Someone who physically can't hold tweezers gets help, narrated clearly, with written steps to take home.

R1 **WAIT.** Say nothing. Count to ten. Most fumbling sorts itself out, and the sorting-out is where the learning happens. New volunteers jump in after about two seconds. Train yourself out of it.

R2 **ASK A QUESTION.** "What's it doing?" · "What do you think is holding it?" · "What did the guide say about that corner?"

R3 **DESCRIBE.** "The tab is on the left edge, about an inch from the corner."

R4 **POINT.** At the spot. Still don't touch the device.

R5 **DEMONSTRATE ON A DIFFERENT DEVICE.** Show the motion on your own practice unit, then hand theirs back. This solves most of what's left, and almost nobody uses it enough.

R6 **GUIDED TOUCH.** "May I put my hand over yours so you can feel the pressure?" Ask first. Their hand stays on the tool.

R7 **YOU TAKE OVER.** Only for an active safety risk, or when going further will kill the device and the attendee asked you to. Announce it, narrate it, and hand it back the second it's past the hard part.

RUN-OF-SHOW & THE PRACTICE-DEVICE POLICY

T-45	Setup: stations, lighting, cords taped down, fireproof container out, tools counted in, walker clearance checked
T-15	Volunteer huddle. First-workshop volunteers get paired, never solo. The Lead makes the stop call.
0:00	Doors. Greeter gets names, sign-in, acknowledgment form, and "what brought you in today?"
0:10	Safety briefing. Every workshop. No exceptions. Two minutes, and nobody touches a tool before it happens.
0:12	Go-around: your name, plus the thing that annoys you most about your device. Write the list up where everyone can see it. That's your agenda.
0:20	Station work. 2 to 4 attendees per instructor. Escalation ladder in effect.
1:00	Cross-pollinate: one person from each station shares what surprised them. Five minutes.
1:40	Hard stop on new disassembly. Close, test, account for everything. An open device at the end of a session goes home broken.
1:50	Close-out: one thing you learned, one thing you'll try at home. Announce the next date.
2:00	Teardown: tools counted out, batteries contained, room left better than you found it. That's how you keep the venue.
+7d	Post-workshop report to TAA

2 TO 4 ATTENDEES / INSTRUCTOR 1 DEVICE / 1 TO 2 ATTENDEES

GROUP BY DEVICE, NOT SKILL NERVOUS FIRST-TIMERS → DESKTOPS

TIER 1 • PRACTICE DEVICES

FULL HANDS-ON, ALWAYS

Donated and scrap hardware the chapter owns. Attendees can take it apart, break it, and do it again, freely. All the invasive teaching happens here. Nobody's data, nobody's property, nobody's grief.

TIER 2 • ATTENDEE DEVICES

NON-INVASIVE ONLY

Software, settings, backups, 2FA setup · battery health readings · external cleaning · port cleaning with a non-metal tool, powered off · diagnosis and a written recommendation.

TIER 3 • OPENING AN ATTENDEE'S DEVICE

ALL EIGHT, OR IT'S TIER 2 + REFERRAL

- | | |
|--|---|
| 1 · Lead is certified and has done this exact repair on a practice unit | 5 · Battery below 25%, or the repair doesn't go near it |
| 2 · Attendee was told out loud it may come back worse, and said yes anyway | 6 · Right part and right tools physically present |
| 3 · Data backed up, or the risk explicitly accepted | 7 · iFixit difficulty moderate or below |
| 4 · Signed acknowledgment on file | 8 · The attendee does the work; you coach |
- Don't negotiate with yourself on this. The pressure to say yes will come from a nice person who really wants their phone fixed. That's exactly the situation the rule exists for.

Why this exists, said plainly: a chapter lead is a volunteer who read a handbook. Fifty of those in fifty towns opening strangers' phones on demand gets you bricked devices, lost family photos, and eventually an injury. Any one of those with TAA's name on it costs us the relationships that make this whole thing run. Practice devices remove nearly all of that risk and almost none of the learning. That's a rare trade, and we take it.

THE FIRST NINETY DAYS

DAYS 1 TO 30 • CERTIFY AND PREPARE

- Finish Modules 1 to 5, the knowledge check, and the certification
- Confirm the venue: room, recurring date, tables, power, storage
- Inventory target: 3 desktops, 3 laptops, 6 phones minimum
- Check every donated desktop for a BIOS lock
- Buy the fireproof container; find your battery recycling point
- Build the referral list; post TAA-template flyers

DAYS 31 TO 60 • FIRST WORKSHOP + A SECOND PERSON

- Workshop 1: keep it small on purpose, 8 to 12 people, never thirty
- Report within seven days
- Find your Co-Lead: attendees who stayed late, venue volunteers. Start them on the handbook.
- Workshop 2

DAYS 61 TO 90 • STABILIZE

- Workshop 3, and provisional becomes full charter
- Co-Lead certified
- Recruit 2 Repair Instructors + 1 Greeter
- Get a recurring date on the venue's own calendar. "Second Saturday every month" gets attendance. "Whenever we can book a room" doesn't.

WHAT THE VENUE NEEDS FROM YOU, IN PRIORITY ORDER

1 • Predictability. Same date, same room, same time. Can't make it? Tell them a week out, not the morning of.

3 • Attendance numbers, in writing, without being asked. Libraries justify their budgets with attendance. This one habit makes you their favorite program.

2 • Not being a problem. Room cleaner than you found it, no overruns, no trip hazards.

4 • No liability surprises, no commerce. "Will you break patrons' property?" The practice-device policy is your answer; say it out loud. And nothing gets sold, ever.

□ OPEN ITEM • INSURANCE

Lots of venues ask for a certificate of insurance naming them as additional insured. If that happens, don't improvise. Contact TAA immediately, and never tell a venue we're covered unless you've been told so in writing. TAA's real coverage position has to be stated here before this goes out.



Your host venue

or [browse files](#)

FIG. 06 • THE HOST VENUE: A ROOM, TABLES, AND A PUBLIC FRONT DOOR

VOLUNTEERS, DEVICES, REPORTING

RECRUITING VOLUNTEERS

Your best source is your own attendees, especially anyone who starts helping the person next to them without being asked. Recruit those people on the spot.

- Retired engineers, technicians, electricians. Every town has them, and they're under-used
- Students who need service hours (they need the most coaching on Module 4)
- The library's volunteer pool, makerspaces, radio clubs

Nobody works a station alone on their first workshop. Nobody handles batteries without Module 1. And check whether your venue requires background checks; many do, and it's their process, not yours to waive.

SOURCING PRACTICE DEVICES

- **Ask your attendees.** The single best source. Every household has dead phones in a drawer, and people love having somewhere for them to go
- TAA's donated inventory (ask; logistics vary by distance)
- Library and town IT retirements
- Local repair shops' scrap bins, which often turns into a referral relationship both ways
- E-waste collection events (ask the organizer first)

Wipe every donated device or pull the drive before it becomes teaching material. Skip this and you'll eventually hand someone a laptop with a stranger's tax returns on it.

REPORTING

Post-workshop report within seven days, every workshop. It takes ten minutes and it's a charter condition. It builds the dataset that proves the program works and gives TAA the numbers sponsors ask about.

Report the bad ones too. A session where four people showed up and a repair failed is more useful to us than a session you never wrote up. We're not grading you on attendance.

WITHIN 24 HOURS: any injury, property damage, battery event, data or privacy incident, venue complaint, or accusation against a volunteer.

50

What "fifty chapters" actually means. A chapter counts once it's run three workshops and filed three reports. Not when someone gets approved, not when a toolkit ships. Thirty inactive chapters is worse than twelve active ones. If you're running out of steam, tell us; a chapter that asks for help is one we can help. A chapter that goes quiet is one we lose.

CERTIFICATION SUBMISSION

SUBMIT ALL SIX ITEMS TOGETHER

- 01 **Knowledge check:** all 68 questions of Part 8, in writing, in your own words
- 02 **Repair video, 5 to 8 minutes:** one complete repair on a practice device, filmed straight through, hands visible. Mat in use, wrist strap clipped, fireproof container in frame for battery work, and the device powering on at the end. If something goes wrong, keep filming. A mistake handled calmly is better evidence than a flawless run.
- 03 **Mock lesson video, 10 minutes:** teach one genuine beginner. We count how many times you touched their device, and whether "just," "simply," or "easy" showed up. A technically perfect lesson where you did the work for them fails. That's the point.
- 04 **Checkpoint evidence:** the photos and short write-ups from all five module checkpoints
- 05 **Your referral list,** completed for your town
- 06 **Chapter plan, one page:** venue and contact, recurring date, inventory, container and disposal point, your Co-Lead prospect, and your first three workshop topics

Also required: at least six completed iFixit guides across four device classes, tracked on your account, plus the foundation reading, from Tools Best Practices to the swollen-battery wiki.

TAA SENDS BACK ONE OF FOUR RESULTS

CERTIFIED

Charter issued, provisional status. Schedule workshop 1.

CERTIFIED WITH NOTES

Approved, with specific fixes we read back to you before workshop 1.

RESUBMIT

Common, and not a rejection. It's usually the mock lesson; the escalation ladder is genuinely hard.

NOT APPROVED

We'll tell you exactly why, including when it's a fit issue instead of a skill issue.

FULL HANDBOOK: PART 8 KNOWLEDGE CHECK · APPENDICES A TO F
SAFETY SCRIPT · FORMS · CHECKLISTS · REFERRAL TEMPLATE · GLOSSARY